

The Dhāraṇī of the Second Verse

Gāthā Dvītīya Dhāraṇī · Toh 611 · Derge Kangyur

ཆགིས་ས་བྱུང་པ་གཉིས་པའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of the Second Verse, known in Sanskrit as the Gāthā Dvītīya Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Tshigs su bcad pa gnyis pa'i gzungs, is a short dhāraṇī text belonging to the class of dhāraṇī and mantra literature within the Buddhist canon. It takes the form of a verse that identifies seven obscurations afflicting sentient beings — including contempt for the Buddha and Dharma, laziness, attachment, and indecision — and declares the supreme vehicle to be their antidote, before presenting a dhāraṇī formula intended to remove the faults of those who obstruct spiritual attainment. The text opens with a homage to Mañjuśrī and closes with praise for the merits of engaging with the dhāraṇī through either its words or its meaning. It is Toh 611 in the Kangyur, catalogued among the dhāraṇī collections of that canon.

In the language of India: Gāthā Dvītīya Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī of the Second Verse.

Homage to Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful.

Contempt for the buddhas and the Dharma,
laziness, and clinging to what is merely sufficient,
acting out of attachment and pride,
remorse, and conduct born of indecision —
these become obscurations for sentient beings.
As the antidote to these, the supreme vehicle is taught;
and all the faults of those who obstruct the attainment thereof
shall be utterly abandoned.

Tadyathā: Oṃ vajraprakāra vajraprakara vajracakra daṃṣṭrābhayanake amale
vimale niramale culuke culuculu sarvabuddhe svāhā.

Whoever, being a noble sentient being endowed with intelligence,
engages with the Dhāraṇī of the Second Verse
through the door of its words or its meaning
shall obtain ten kinds of benefit.

All their elements shall be made fully pure;
at the time of death they shall attain supreme and sublime joy;
they shall be reborn as they wish;

in all their lives they shall remember their previous existences;
they shall come to meet the buddhas;
and from them they shall hear the supreme vehicle;
they shall become inspired and possessed of intelligence;
and through the twofold door they shall swiftly attain awakening.

The Dhāraṇī of the Second Verse is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "twofold door" is ambiguous; it likely refers to the two doors of śamatha and vipaśyanā, calm abiding and insight, which together constitute the standard pair of meditative approaches leading to awakening. Some traditions read it as the twofold accumulation of merit and wisdom. Both are plausible in context.

The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering and represent Sanskrit imperfectly preserved; the reconstruction offered follows standard conventions for this dhāraṇī literature but the Sanskrit Vorlage cannot be verified with certainty from the Tibetan alone.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.